MIL-O-43517A(GL)
30 August 1977
SUPERSEDING
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11 August 1967

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

ORNAMENTATION (ARMY BAND)

This specification is approved for use by US Army Natick Research and Development Command, Department of the Army, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for ornamentation used with caps and uniforms of U.S. Army Bands.

1.2 Classification. The ornamentation shall be of the following types:

Type I	-	Breast Cord
Type II	-	Shoulder Knot
Type III	-	Cord, Service Cap

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

V-T-276	-	Thread, Cotton
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: US Army Natick Research and Development Command, Natick, MA 01760 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 8455

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PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup
PPP-T-45 - Tape, Gummed, Paper, Reinforced and Plain, for Sealing and Securing

MILITARY

MIL-B-3461 - Button, Insignia, Metal, Uniform and Cap

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-191 - Textile Test Methods

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

COLOR ASSOCIATION OF THE UNITED STATES, INC.

Department of Defense Standard Shades for Heraldic Yarns for Embroidery and Ribbons 1974

(Application for copies should be addressed to The Color Association of the United States, Inc., 200 Madison Avenue, New York, NY 10016.)

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

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UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Samples.

3.1.1 Guide samples. Guide samples of the end item, when furnished, are solely for guidance and information to the contractor (see 6.3). Variations from this specification may appear in the sample, in which case this specification shall govern.

3.1.2 Standard sample. The finished ornamentation shall match the standard sample for shade and shall be equal to or better than the standard sample with respect to all characteristics for which the standard sample is referenced (see 6.3).

3.1.3 First article. When specified (see 6.2), the contractor shall furnish a sample for first article inspection and approval (see 4.3 and 6.4).

3.2 Materials.

* 3.2.1 Rayon yarn. The rayon yarn used in braiding the cord cover shall be a continuous multifilament cellulose rayon, 450 denier (50 tex), 3 ply, 6 turns per inch (2 turns/cm) and shall be yarn dyed. The direction of the twist of the plied yarn shall be opposite from the twist direction of the single yarn. As an alternate, braiding cord cover yarns may be continuous multifilament 420 denier (47 tex) nylon or 440 denier (48 tex) polyester.

* 3.2.2 Cotton yarn. The cotton 3 ply yarn used for the core of the braided cord shall be made of three ends of size number 8 yarn (74 tex) nominal. The cotton shall be yarn dyed.

* 3.3 Color. The color of the finished braided cord and core shall be Goldenlight HG cable No. 67107 (see 2.2). The use of sulfur dyes and dyes containing elementary sulfur or compounds capable of oxidation to sulfuric acid is prohibited. The dyed braided cord and core shall show no more labile sulfur than that shown by the standard sample when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

3.3.1 Matching. The color shall match the standard sample under artificial daylight having a color temperature of 7500 kelvin, and shall be a good approximation to the standard sample under incandescent lamplight at 2800 kelvin.

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3.3.2 Colorfastness. The dyed braided cord and core shall show fastness to wet drycleaning and light equal to or better than the standard sample. When no standard sample is available, the dyed braided cord and core shall show good fastness to wet drycleaning and light when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

3.4 Cloth, backing (for shoulder knots). The cloth covering the backing of the shoulder knots shall be a woolen cloth, 12 to 16 ounces per linear yard (262 to 349 g/m^2), in a dark blue shade approximating Army shade Blue 150 or in a Black shade.

3.4.1 Colorfastness. The dyed cloth shall show fastness to wet drycleaning and light equal to or better than the standard sample. When no standard is available the dyed cloth shall show good fastness to wet drycleaning and light when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

* 3.5 Braided cord construction. The tubular braided cord cover shall be made of rayon, nylon or polyester yarn (see 3.2.1). The core shall be made of cotton yarns (see 3.2.2).

* 3.5.1 Cord cover. The tubular braided cord cover shall be braided on a 16 carrier machine with two ends per carrier. The cord shall be 7/32 inch (6 mm) in diameter (minimum) for the outer covering and braided over the core yarns with a two over, two under braiding type having not less than 16 picks per inch (6 picks/cm).

3.5.2 Core. The core shall consist of 34 yarns.

3.6 Thread. The thread for stitching shall be mercerized cotton conforming to type IC2, ticket No. A, 3 ply of V-T-276. The shade of thread for the breast cord and service cap cord shall approximate Goldenlight AJ, C.A. 66051. The shade of thread for the shoulder knot shall approximate the dark blue or black color of the material used on underside of shoulder knot.

3.6.1 Colorfastness. The dyed thread shall show fastness to wet drycleaning and light equal to or better than the standard sample. When no standard sample is available, the dyed thread shall show good fastness to wet drycleaning and light.

* 3.7 Button, metal. The regulation Army gold-plated short shank or hopper back button for the shoulder knot shall conform to type I, style 2, class A, size 25-line of MIL-B-3461.

* 3.8 Snap fasteners. Snap fasteners for the shoulder knot shall be a commercial brass sew-on type, size 2/0 with a Japan black or black chemical finish.

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* 3.9 Hooks. The hooks used to attach the breast cord to the uniform shall be nickel plated brass hooks measuring approximately 7/8 inch (22 mm) in length (see figure 1).

3.10 Ferrule and ring. The ferrule and ring for the breast cord shall be made of brass in the design and dimensions as shown in figure 1. The brass shall be a copper alloy, 60-72 percent copper. The ferrule and ring shall be wheel polished to a mirror-like finish and lacquered with a clear lacquer. The use of pigmented lacquer shall not be permitted.

3.11 Figures. Figures 1, 2, and 3 are furnished for information purposes only. To the extent of any inconsistencies between the written specification and the figures, the written specification shall govern.

3.12 Fabrication.

* 3.12.1 Type 1 (breast cord). The breast cord shall consist of two chain plaited cords joined at each end. Each joining shall terminate in two plain cords (see enlarged view of cord plating design in figure 1) with a ferrule and ring at free end of each plain cord. Plaited section "A-A", shall be firmly and evenly plaited with approximately 42 plaits in 23-1/2 ± 1/2 inches (59.7 ± 13 mm), and plaited section "B-B", shall be firmly and evenly plaited with approximately 52 plaits in 26-1/2 ± 1/2 inches (67.3 ± 13 mm). A nickel plated brass hook shall be securely stitched to back of joining of chain plaited cords (see figure 1).

* 3.12.1.1 Ferrule and ring. Attach ferrule and ring to bottom end of cord by inserting cord through ring into opening in top of ferrule, and sewing with thread through the cord and the four holes in the ferrule and around the top of ferrule to provide sufficient friction to hold the covering ring in place over the top of the ferrule.

3.12.2 Type 2 (shoulder knot). The braided cord shall be plaited to form the design of the finished shoulder knot, with a 25 line gold-plated button (see 3.7) sewn to back near the end of the shoulder knot. The underside of the shoulder knot shall be stiffened with a flexible backing, covered with dark blue or black woolen cloth sewn securely to the under edges of the cord. The tolerance for length shall be ± 1/8 inch (3 mm) and for widths ± 1/16 inch (2 mm) (see figure 2).

3.12.2.1 Snap fasteners. When the manufacturer of the coat is furnished or furnishes shoulder knots at time of coat making, there shall be sewn on to the backs of the shoulder knots three snap fasteners in positions indicated in figure 2 corresponding to locations of snap fasteners on the uniform coat.

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3.12.3 Type 3 (service cap cord). The cap cord shall be formed by plaiting in a chain arrangement ending in a plain braided cord loop at each end as shown in figure 3. There shall be approximately 28 chain loops in 11-1/2 plus 1/8 minus 0 inches (292 + 3 -0 mm). The ends of the cord shall be neatly turned under and securely attached. The finished cap cords shall be evenly and firmly braided and plaited.

3.13 Workmanship. The finished ornamentation shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

* 4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificate of compliance. Where certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

* 4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3)
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4)

* 4.3 First article inspection. When required (see 6.2), the first article submitted in accordance with 3.1.3 shall be visually inspected as specified in 4.4.2.1 and 4.4.2.2 for compliance with design, construction, workmanship, material, and dimensional requirements.

* 4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

* 4.4.1 Components and materials inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase documents.

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In addition to the quality assurance provisions of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards, testing shall be performed on components listed in table I for the characteristics shown. The test methods listed in table I shall be in accordance with FED-STD-191 wherever applicable. The sample unit for the yarn shall be one spool, cone, or tube. The sample unit for the backing cloth shall be one linear yard (0.91 m). The sample size shall be in accordance with table II. The lot shall be unacceptable if one or more units fail to meet any test requirements specified.

TABLE I. Component testing

Component and lot expressed in terms of	Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test method
Rayon yarn for cord cover (one cone, spool, or tube)	Material identification	3.2.1	1/
	Yarn size	3.2.1	1/
	Ply	3.2.1	Visual 2/
	Twist	3.2.1	4054
Cotton yarn for core of cord (one cone, spool, or tube)	Material identification	3.2.2	1/
	Yarn size	3.2.2	1/
	Ply	3.2.2	Visual 2/
Cord, braided and core (one cone, spool, or tube)	Labile sulfur	3.3	2020 1/
	Colorfastness:		
	- wet drycleaning	3.3.2	5622
	- to light	3.3.2	5660
Cloth backing (for shoulder knot only) (1 linear yard) (0.91 m)	Weight	3.4	1/
	Colorfastness:		
	- to wet drycleaning	3.4.1	5622
	- to light	3.4.1	5660
Cover	Number of carriers	3.5.1	Visual 3/
	Ends per carrier	3.5.1	Visual 3/
	Picks per inch	3.5	Visual 4/
	Braiding type	3.5	Visual 2/
Core	Number of ends	3.5.2	Visual 3/
Snap fasteners (for shoulder knot only)	Material identification	3.8	1/
	Size	3.8	1/
	Finish	3.8	1/

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TABLE I. Component testing (cont'd)

Component and lot expressed in terms of	Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test method
Ferrule and ring (for breast cord only)	Material identification	3.10	1/

1/ A contractor's certificate of compliance will be acceptable for this characteristic.

2/ One determination per sample unit and the results reported as "pass or fail".

3/ One determination per sample unit and the results reported as "actual count".

4/ Three determinations per sample unit and results reported as the average of three determinations to the nearest whole number.

TABLE II. Sample size for testing

Lot size (units)	Sample size
800 or less	2
801 up to and including 22,000	3
22,001 and over	5

4.4.2 Examination of the end item. The defects found during examination of the end item shall be classified in accordance with 4.4.2.1 and 4.4.2.2. The applicable inspection levels and acceptable quality levels shall be as indicated in 4.4.3. The sample unit for this examination shall be one ornamentation and selection of the sample of shoulder knots only shall be by pairs. Defects for pairing (shoulder knots only) shall be classified as a single defect. The lot size shall be expressed in terms of one ornamentation.

* 4.4.2.1 Visual examination of ornamentation. The ornamentation shall be examined for defects in color, design, construction, material, and workmanship as indicated in table III.

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TABLE III. Classification of visual examination defects

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Cord	Color or shade not as specified	X	
	Not fabricated from specified material	X	
	Spotted, stained, discolored, or soiled	X	
	Cut or tear	X	
	Broken or missing yarn	X	
	Core not completely covered	X	
	Core not dyed	X	
Construction and workmanship	Plaiting is not as specified or not as shown on the applicable figure	X	
	Unevenly or loosely plaited		X
	Tacking not neatly accomplished		X
	Stitching thread wrong shade or color, i.e., does not correspond to required color	X	
Type I (breast cord)	Ferrule or ring missing	X	
	Ferrule or ring not fabricated from brass	X	
	Ferrule or ring not wheel polished to a mirror-like finish	X	
	Ferrule or ring not lacquered	X	
	Ferrule or ring not lacquered with transparent lacquer		X
	One or more hooks missing	X	
	Hook not brass, nickel plated	X	
Type II (shoulder knot)	One or more snap fasteners missing	X	
	Snap fasteners not securely sewn on		X
	Back of shoulder knot not covered with backing cloth	X	
	Backing cloth not sewn to back of cord	X	
	Button missing	X	

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TABLE III. Classification of visual examination defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Type II (shoulder knot) (cont'd)	Japan black or chemical black finish missing from snap fastener	X	
	Button not correctly placed	X	
	Button not securely attached to the shoulder knot		X

4.4.2.2 Dimensional examination. The ornamentation shall be examined for dimensional defects. Any dimension that is not within the established tolerance shall be classified a defect.

4.4.3 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQLs). The inspection levels and the AQLs expressed in defects per hundred units shall be as follows:

	Inspection level	AQL Major	AQL Total
For defects applicable to 4.4.2.1	II	2.5	6.5
For defects applicable to 4.4.2.2	S-3	-	4.0

* 4.4.4 Packaging inspection. An examination shall be made to determine that preservation-packaging, packing, and marking comply with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be closed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

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Examine	Defect
Materials	Any component missing. Any component damaged, affecting serviceability.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of case liners, container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Bulged or distorted container.
Content	Number of items per intermediate package is more or less than required. Number of intermediate packages per container is more or less than required.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation-packaging. Preservation-packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit packaging. One pair of shoulder knots, one cap cord, or one breast cord shall be individually placed in a flat-style clear polyethylene bag of .00125 inch (0.03 mm) thickness (± 20 percent tolerance). The polyethylene bag shall be formed with heat sealed seams that are straight, continuous and parallel to each other and the formed edges of the bag. The bag closure shall be effected by heat sealing with the heat seal as close as possible to the open end. A 1/4 inch (6 mm) diameter hole shall be made at one corner of each bag to allow the excess air to escape.

5.1.1.2 Intermediate packaging. Twenty pairs of shoulder knots, twenty cap cords, or ten breast cords bagged as specified in 5.1.1.1, shall be packaged, respectively, in a snug-fitting setup paperboard box conforming to type I, variety 1, style 4 of PPP-B-676. Box closure shall be secured with 2 inch (51 mm) minimum width gummed paper tape conforming to type III, grade B of PPP-T-45, applied at the center of the length opening and extending along the bottom and up each side at least one half the depth of the box.

* 5.1.2 Level C. Shoulder knots, cap cords, and breast cords shall be preserved-packaged to afford adequate protection against physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The package and quantity per package shall be the same as that normally used by the contractor for retail distribution.

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5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A packing. One hundred pairs of shoulder knots, one hundred cap cords, or one hundred breast cords, preserved-packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.4.

5.2.2 Level B packing. One hundred pairs of shoulder knots, one hundred cap cords, or one hundred breast cords, preserved-packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, type CF, variety SW or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.4.

5.2.2.1 Weather-resistant container. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box, fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.4.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Shoulder knots, cap cords, and breast cords, preserved-packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such suppliers. The quantity per shipping container shall be the same as that normally used by the contractor for retail distribution. Containers shall comply with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, intermediate packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The ornamentations are intended for use as uniform accessories by personnel of U.S. Army Bands.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type required (see 1.2).

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(c) When a first article is required (see 3.1.3).
(d) Selection of applicable levels of preservation-packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(e) When weather-resistant grade shipping containers are required for level B shipment (see 5.2.2.1).

6.3 Samples. For access to samples, address the procuring activity issuing the invitation for bids.

* 6.4 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of ASPR 7-104.55. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The first article should consist of one finished ornamentation. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all procurement instruments regarding arrangements for inspection and approval of the first article.

* 6.5 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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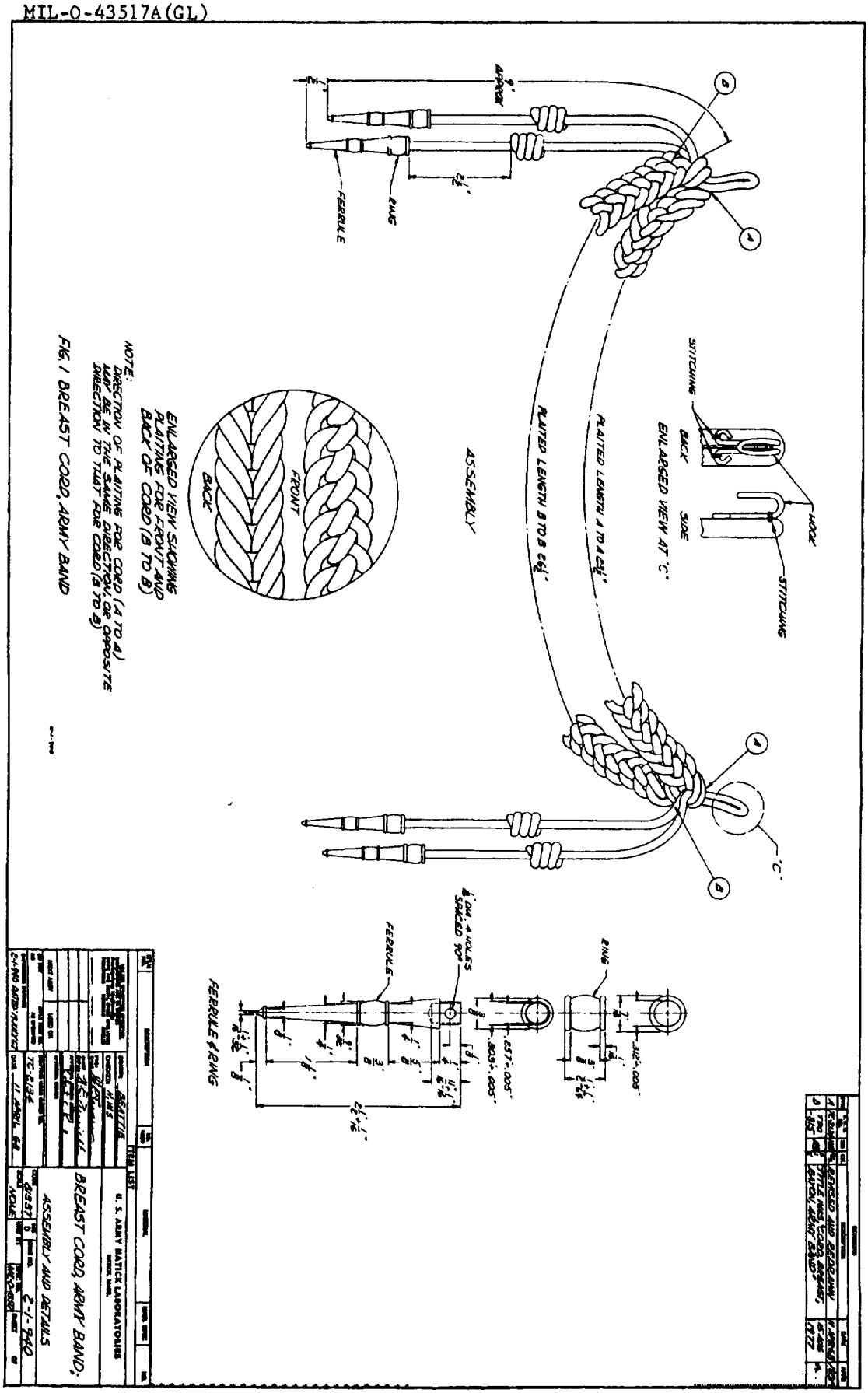
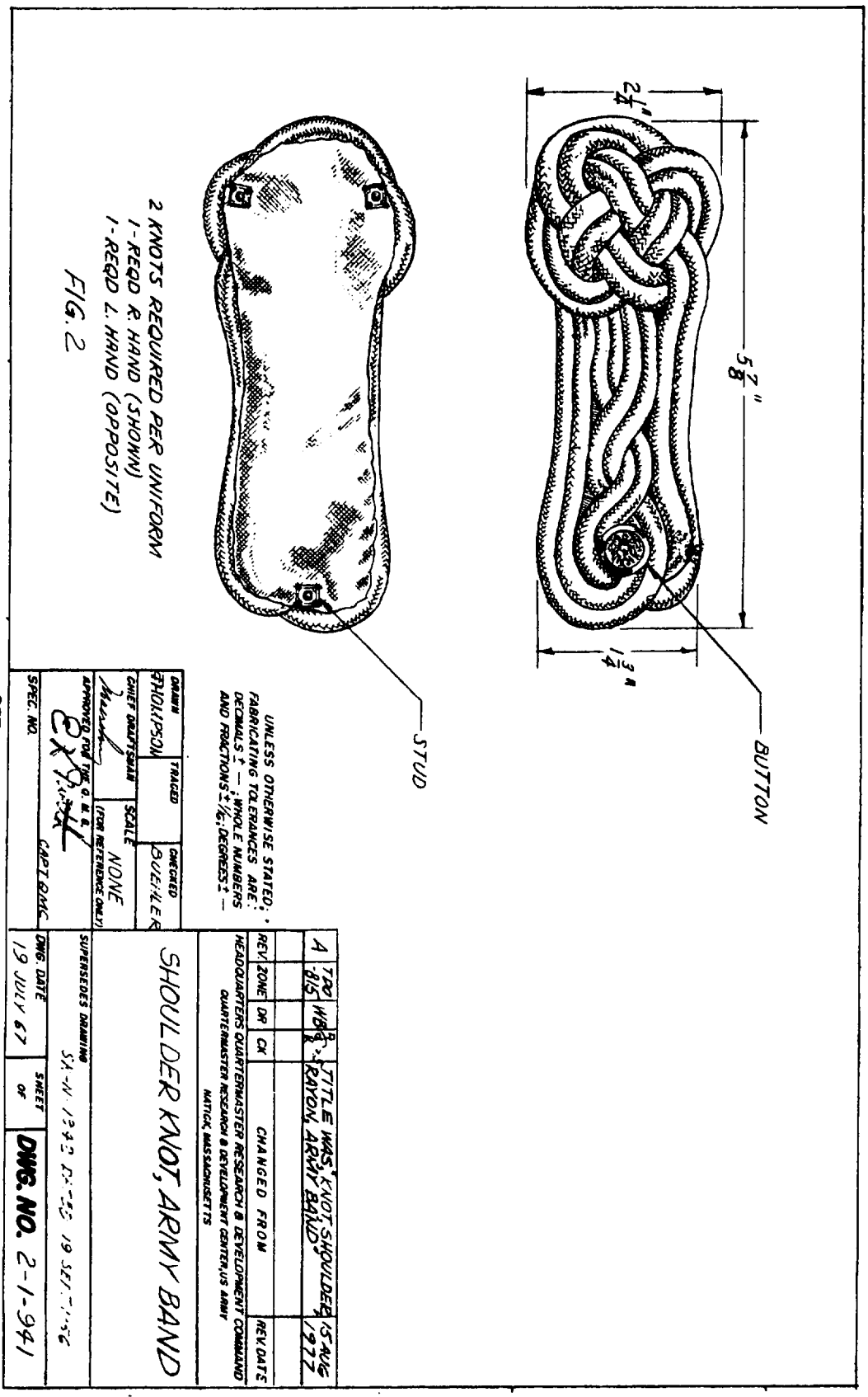


FIG. 1 BREAST CORD, ARMY BAND

ENLARGED VIEW SHOWING PLAITING FOR FRONT AND BACK OF CORD (B TO B)

NOTE: DIRECTION OF PLAITING FOR CORD (A TO A) MAY BE IN THE SAME DIRECTION, OR OPPOSITE DIRECTION TO THAT FOR CORD (B TO B)

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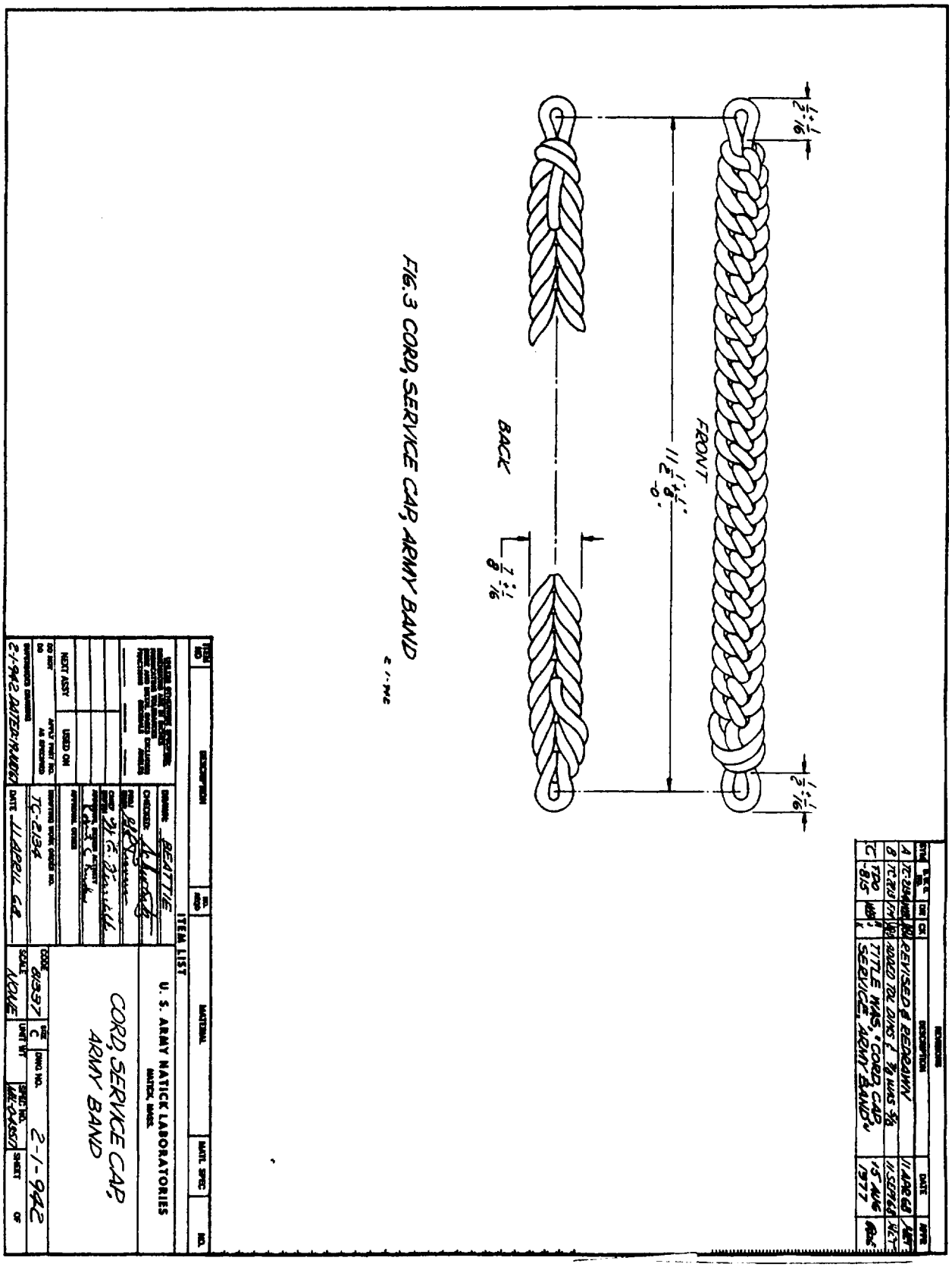


FIG. 3 CORD, SERVICE CAP, ARMY BAND

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